

ASUS ROG Pelta gaming headset

A lightweight champion with a heavyweight price tag

Having spent the last few weeks living with the ASUS ROG Pelta, and I have come to a complicated conclusion. In a vacuum, this is one of the most comfortable and immersive headsets I have ever worn. But we do not live in a vacuum. We live in a market where pricing dictates value, and that is where the Pelta's story gets interesting.

When I first pulled the Pelta out of the box, the inspiration was unmistakable. The tall oval earcups, the half-arc yokes, and that signature elastic suspension headband all scream Steel-Series Arctis Nova. I am not complaining because that is a great design philosophy. Weighing in at 309g, it is technically mid-weight, but once I adjusted that elastic band, it felt like it disappeared. It floats on the head rather than sitting on it.

However, that comfort comes with a trade-off I discovered the hard way. The clamping force is incredibly light. While this is a blessing for marathon sessions where I usually get headaches, it means the headset lacks grip. During a particularly intense moment when I failed to clutch for the 100th time in Valorant, I snapped my head back in frustration and felt the Pelta slide to the back. If you are an expressive gamer who moves a lot, this thing will slip off.

THE DAILY DRIVE: BUTTONS AND THE QUIRKS

ASUS has put all the controls on the left earcup, which I appreciate for muscle



of luck because you don't get a 3.5 mm to USB-C converter either. The 3.5 mm port exists, but it is exclusively for the detachable boom mic.

Speaking of the mic, I was genuinely impressed. Out of the box, the background static is barely noticeable, which is a win for wireless headsets. However, I still dove into ASUS's rather Bloat-heavy Armoury Crate software to see if I could fine-tune it, a ritual every ASUS user knows too well. I tried the "Perfect Voice" feature, but it strangely

boosted the high frequencies and whatever minimal static existed. The Echo Cancellation just added digital artifacts that made me sound robotic. Eventually, I found that applying a small noise gate was the secret sauce. Once dialed in, my voice was clear, full, and easily better than my usual wired headsets.

IMMERSION AND THE LATENCY TEST

The audio performance is where I stopped worrying about the buttons and started getting lost in the game. The 50 mm titanium-plated drivers deliver a soundstage that feels expansive. To test just how fast this wireless connection really is, I set up a latency test with two outputs from the same input. I compared the Pelta against a wired audio interface reference point. The result was a delay of just 20 ms. That is practically instantaneous.

I put that speed and soundstage to the test in Resident Evil 4 Remake. I have played this game to death, but the Pelta managed to make the Ganados scary again. Creeping through the village paths felt genuinely nerve-wracking. It wasn't just hearing Leon's footsteps. I could hear a rake scraping on my right, faint but distinct. On my left, the low growl of an enemy shuffled through the earcup so clearly I almost flinched. When a frantic gasp whipped across the stereo field, my pulse spiked. The directional clarity allowed me to react instantly, swinging around to line up a shotgun blast. That is the kind of performance that justifies a premium tag.

When you step away from gaming to watch movies or listen to music, the experience shifts slightly. For movies, the wide soundstage works wonders, giving action sequences plenty of breathing room and keeping dialogue crisp and centered even during chaotic scenes. Music, however, is a mixed bag. The mids and highs are tuned beautifully, making vocals and acoustic instruments sound sharp and detailed. But if you are a bass-head, you might be disappointed. Even with the bass